possible mainly by the regular flow of huge quantities of intelligence over a period of years from the Mossad's branch in Iran.

This is also the place to correct what in my opinion was a historical injustice done to Meki. The operation of the bringing of the Iraqi MiG 21 to Israel has long been recognized as one of the finest feathers in the cap of Israeli intelligence. Who did not bask in the glory of this success? Among the roar of the pyrotechnics and festivities, the role of Meki, who contributed greatly to the HUMINT portion of the operation, especially in its early stages, was never mentioned.

In Ben-Gurion's geostrategic doctrine, Iran played a central role in his "triangles" theory, which argued that Israel had to develop tripartite regional alliances, such as Israel-Turkey-Iran or Israel- Ethiopia-Morocco. Meki served two terms in Iran, the first in the early 1950s and the second in the 1960s. He saw as his main task the supplying of intelligence to respond to the Israeli EEI, but his presence and his work in Iran gave important added value to the realization of the concept of tripartite alliances. Meki taught the Iranians what intelligence was and why a country that has enemies needs it. He piqued their curiosity and their desire to learn and thus developed their dependence on us, which enabled our freedom of action in this country for decades.

Meki was not an easy man. He stuck by his opinions, and as far as the intelligence profession was concerned he fought tooth and nail for what he believed in; when he was convinced of his position, opinion, recommendation, or decision, he was impossible to budge. Meki, who was a classic HUMINT man, witnessed the development of the new intelligence disciplines such as SIGINT, COMINT and VISINT, and it was hard for him to get used to the changing world. He also feared that these new professions would replace HUMINT, which he referred to not as a profession but as an art.

Yael and I served under quite a few commanders in our thirty-two years in the Mossad. Meki and Ruthie were our first commanders on our first mission abroad as a newlywed couple. Luckily for us, they liked us. The way they treated us and took care of us—Yael arrived in Tehran at the beginning of her first pregnancy—served me throughout my entire career in the Mossad as the model of how a superior should treat his subordinates in all aspects of the mission abroad, which cannot be separated from the work itself.